IM0802 – Responsible Artificial Intelligence
Assignment 1: Deepfakes in time of conflict or war

Harman Singh[1]
852863316

1 Introduction

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A United Nations Security Council meeting is underway to vote on a ceasefire agreement. The conflict in question has been ongoing for years, with both sides accusing each other of war crimes and atrocities with little concrete evidence to support either claim. That is, until a video surfaces online showing militants from one side of the conflict carrying out organised killings of unarmed civilians in a disputed border region. The video quickly goes viral, is shared by news outlets and social media, and sparks outrage worldwide. Protests are organised by human rights organisations in major cities, trending hashtags call for justice, and the video becomes a rallying point for condemnation of the accused nation. Diplomats and politicians condemn the actions, and the UN Security Council votes to impose sanctions on the accused nation based on the video evidence. The accused nation denies the allegations, claiming the video is fabricated, but the damage is done. Diplomatic relations have been severed and economic sanctions are in place. These economic sanctions eventually lead to the accused nation's economy collapsing and them being forced to withdraw from the conflict.

However, there is more to the story. The killings never happened. The video was a deepfake, generated by the government of the opposing nation to discredit the accused nation. Generative artificial intelligence has made significant advancements, with recently the footage being almost indistinguishable from real footage. Until not very long ago, deepfakes were not very convincing, and were mostly used for entertainment purposes. But in 2026, the advancements of generative artificial intelligence could very well be used to fabricate a video with deepfake technology to influence international diplomacy. This essay will explore the ethical implications of deepfakes in time of conflict or war

2 Issue

3 Solution

References

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[2] John Smith and Jane Doe. An innovative approach to machine learning. *Journal of Machine Learning Research*, 21(101):1–20, 2020.